



SoundForge — Front-End Skills Challenge

Student Instructions

Deadline: Friday 3 July 2026, 17:00 (Malta time) · Effort: ~4-6 hours

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Welcome

Thanks for taking part. This is a short, practical task to see how you work with **HTML, CSS, responsive design, Git, and following a design spec**. It is not a trick test — we want to see clean, honest work.

You have until Friday 3 July 2026 (17:00, Malta time) — a few days, so there's time to research and learn as you go. The task itself should only take about **4-6 focused hours**; you don't need to spend more. Don't burn yourself out chasing perfection — finishing the core requirements well beats a half-built “wow” feature.

This document contains everything you need: the setup, the assignment, and the full design spec. Your starter code is in the accompanying **starter/** folder (starter/index.html and starter/css/styles.css are already stubbed out for you).

Stuck or rusty? See **RESOURCES.pdf** in this folder — a cheat sheet with documentation links and code patterns for HTML, CSS layout, responsive design, and Git. It's there to help you, and using it is encouraged.

Getting set up

No build tools are needed. To preview the page, either:

- **Easiest:** double-click starter/index.html to open it in your browser, or
- **Recommended (live reload):** if you use VS Code, install the *Live Server* extension, right-click starter/index.html and choose “Open with Live Server”.

To check responsiveness, open your browser's DevTools (F12), toggle the device toolbar, and test at **375 px**, **768 px**, and **1280 px**.

The scenario

A fictional music-tech meetup called **SoundForge** needs a one-page marketing site to announce its next event and sell tickets. We've given you a starter folder, this spec, and the exact content to use. Your job is to turn the spec into a finished, responsive landing page.

You are **not** working on any real or production project. Everything you need is in this challenge folder. Build only here.

What you must build

Build a **single responsive landing page** (index.html + css/styles.css) with these six sections, in this order:

1. **Header / nav bar** — logo on the left, nav links on the right. Must collapse sensibly on mobile (a simple stacked menu or a hamburger — your choice).
2. **Hero** — event name, tagline, date and location, and a primary “Get Tickets” button.
3. **About** — a short blurb plus three feature cards (icon + heading + text).
4. **Schedule** — the day's agenda as a clean, readable list or table.
5. **Speakers** — four speaker cards (photo placeholder + name + role).
6. **Tickets (call-to-action) + Footer** — a pricing CTA and a footer with links.

All content (text, names, times, prices) is provided in the **Design Spec** below — use it as given. Don't invent your own copy; following the spec is part of what we're assessing.

It must be responsive

Work correctly at three widths, with **no horizontal scrolling** and no overlapping or cut-off text at any of them:

- **Mobile** — 375 px
- **Tablet** — 768 px
- **Desktop** — 1280 px

Stick to the design tokens

Colours, fonts, and spacing are defined as CSS variables in the starter `css/styles.css`. **Use those variables** rather than hard-coding random values. Matching the spec matters more than personal restyling.

Rules

- **Plain HTML and CSS only.** No frameworks (no Bootstrap, Tailwind, React, etc.) and no build tools. We want to see *your* HTML and CSS.
- **Vanilla JavaScript is allowed but optional** — only if a feature needs it (e.g. a mobile menu toggle). Keep it small and readable. The task can be completed with zero JS.
- **No copying a full template.** Small references for syntax are fine; submitting someone else's page is not.
- **Images:** use the placeholders provided (or any free-to-use placeholder). Don't spend your day hunting for assets.

How to submit (Git workflow — this is assessed)

We want to see that you can use Git properly, not just write code. From inside the challenge folder (a VS Code terminal works fine):

```
# 1. Start a repo (its default branch is "main") and make a clean first commit
git init
git add .
git commit -m "Initial commit: challenge starter files"

# 2. Build the page, committing in small steps as you go
git add .
git commit -m "Add header and hero section"
# (repeat with clear messages: "Add about cards", "Make nav responsive", etc.)

# 3. Create an EMPTY repo on your own GitHub account (no README or licence),
#     copy its URL, connect it, and push your "main" branch:
git remote add origin https://github.com/<your-username>/soundforge-
challenge.git
git push -u origin main
```

That's it — your work now lives on main in your own repository. You **don't** need to open a Pull Request: it's your own solo repo, so there's nothing to merge into. If you're comfortable with branches and want to show it, you're welcome to do your work on a feature/landing-page branch and push that too — a nice bonus, but not required.

Work in **small, meaningful commits** with clear messages — we'd rather see six small, clear commits than one giant "did everything" commit. If you've never used Git before, getting it slightly wrong is fine; we'd rather see you attempt the workflow than skip it.

Finally, fill in `NOTES.md` with what you finished, anything you didn't get to, and roughly how long it took.

Submitting your link — step by step

When you're done, this is exactly how to hand your work in:

1. **Make your repository public** (Settings → General → change visibility to Public). If you'd rather keep it private, tell us and add us as a collaborator instead.
2. **Confirm everything is pushed** — your commits and your main branch should all be visible on GitHub, and `NOTES.md` should be filled in.
3. **Add your submission to the shared sheet**: open the submission sheet (the link is provided with this task) and, in the next empty row, enter **your full name** and the **link to your GitHub repository**. That's all we need.

Deadline: Friday 3 July 2026, 17:00 (Malta time). If you get stuck on the Git steps, push what you have and add a note on where you got stuck — an honest partial submission is better than none.

How it's evaluated

Area	What a strong submission shows
Follows the spec	Sections, content, colours, fonts and spacing match the spec.
Responsive design	Looks good and works at 375 / 768 / 1280 px. No overflow or breakage.
HTML quality	Semantic tags (header, nav, section, footer), sensible structure, valid markup.
CSS quality	Uses the design tokens, organised and readable, no huge duplication.
Git workflow	Repo initialised, several clear commits with good messages, pushed to your own GitHub repo, link shared.
Polish & judgement	Tidy details, consistent spacing, good decisions where the spec leaves room.

We are **not** judging you on pixel-perfection, fancy animations, JavaScript wizardry, or design originality. Clear, correct, spec-following work is the goal.

Design Spec

Build the page to match this spec. The design tokens below are already defined as CSS variables in `css/styles.css` — **use the variables**, don't hard-code colours or random pixel values.

Design tokens — colours

Token	Value	Use
<code>--color-bg</code>	<code>#0E0B1A</code>	Page background (dark)
<code>--color-surface</code>	<code>#1A1530</code>	Cards, nav, raised panels
<code>--color-text</code>	<code>#F2F0F7</code>	Primary text
<code>--color-text-muted</code>	<code>#A39FB8</code>	Secondary / supporting text
<code>--color-primary</code>	<code>#7C5CFF</code>	Buttons, links, highlights (violet)
<code>--color-primary-hover</code>	<code>#9B80FF</code>	Hover state for primary
<code>--color-accent</code>	<code>#22D3A6</code>	Secondary accent (teal) — prices, small highlights
<code>--color-border</code>	<code>#2C2545</code>	Card / divider borders

This is a **dark theme**. Keep good contrast — muted text on the dark background, white-ish headings.

Design tokens — typography

Font family: **Poppins** for headings, **Inter** for body. Both are loaded from Google Fonts in the starter `index.html`. Fall back to `sans-serif`.

Token	Size	Weight	Use
<code>--fs-hero</code>	<code>clamp(2.5rem, 6vw, 4rem)</code>	700	Hero headline
<code>--fs-h2</code>	<code>2rem</code>	600	Section headings
<code>--fs-h3</code>	<code>1.25rem</code>	600	Card titles
<code>--fs-body</code>	<code>1rem</code>	400	Body text
<code>--fs-small</code>	<code>0.875rem</code>	400	Labels, footer

Line height: 1.6 for body, 1.2 for headings.

Design tokens — spacing

Use these step values (already variables): `--space-1`: 4px, `--space-2`: 8px, `--space-3`: 16px, `--space-4`: 24px, `--space-5`: 40px, `--space-6`: 64px, `--space-7`: 96px.

- Section vertical padding: `--space-7` desktop, `--space-6` tablet, `--space-5` mobile.
- Content max width: **1120px**, centred, with `--space-4` side padding.
- Card border radius: 16px (`--radius`). Buttons: 999px (pill) or 12px — your call, be consistent.
- Subtle card border using `--color-border`; an optional soft shadow is fine.

Layout per section

“Columns” below refer to **desktop**. On tablet, three- and four-column grids become two columns; on mobile everything stacks to a single column.

Header / nav (sticky optional)

- Left: **SoundForge** wordmark (a text logo is fine, with a violet accent on “Forge”).
- Right: nav links — About, Schedule, Speakers, Tickets.
- Mobile (375 px): links collapse — either a hamburger toggle (needs a little JS) or a simple stacked / wrapped menu. No links should overflow off-screen.

Hero

- Centred or left-aligned (your choice, keep it clean).
- Headline: **“Where Music Meets Technology”**
- Sub-tagline: **“A one-day meetup for producers, developers, and sound designers.”**
- Event meta line: **“Saturday, 12 September 2026 · Valletta, Malta”** (you may prefix a small calendar icon).
- Primary button: **“Get Tickets”** (links to #tickets).
- Secondary text link: **“View schedule”** (links to #schedule).

About — heading “Why SoundForge?”

Intro paragraph:

“SoundForge brings together the people building the future of sound. Spend a day learning, jamming, and connecting with a community that lives where creativity and code overlap.”

Three feature cards (three columns desktop, one on mobile). Each has a small icon/emoji of your choice, a heading, and a line of text:

1. **Hands-on Workshops** (*suggested icon: mixing-desk knobs*) — “Practical sessions on production, DSP, and live performance tools.”
2. **Real Connections** (*suggested icon: handshake*) — “Meet producers, audio devs, and founders from across the scene.”
3. **Fresh Ideas** (*suggested icon: rocket*) — “Talks on AI in music, new instruments, and where the industry is heading.”

Schedule — heading “Schedule”

Present this agenda as a readable list or simple table (time + session + speaker):

Time	Session	Speaker
09:30	Doors open & coffee	—
10:00	Keynote: The Sound of 2030	Lena Hart
11:00	Workshop: Building a Web Synth	Marco Vella

Time	Session	Speaker
12:30	Lunch & networking	—
13:30	Panel: AI in Music Production	All speakers
15:00	Workshop: Mixing for Streaming	Priya Anand
16:30	Live set & closing	Dani Cohen

Speakers — heading “Speakers”

Four speaker cards (four columns desktop, two on tablet, one on mobile). Each has a square photo placeholder, a name, and a role:

1. **Lena Hart** — Founder, ToneLab
2. **Marco Vella** — Audio Engineer, Relay
3. **Priya Anand** — Mixing Engineer
4. **Dani Cohen** — Producer & DJ

Tickets (call-to-action) — heading “Tickets”

- Heading: **“Grab your spot”**
- A single ticket card containing:
 - Label: **“General Admission”**
 - Price: **“€39”** (use --color-accent)
 - Includes line: “All talks, workshops, lunch, and the after-party.”
 - Button: **“Get Tickets”**
- Keep it centred and prominent.

Footer

- Left: **SoundForge** plus a small line: “© 2026